

1 col AD



Make sure you configure your security settings before playing Excel games

How do they make them?

Most games in Excel are programmed using Visual Basic for Applications (VBA). Recording macros involves writing small programs to do the tasks you are recording. Since the language used is VBA, coding in it provides you greater control over your macros.

Here's a small example that shows you how powerful VBA is. Open a new workbook in Excel 2000, and press [Alt] + [F11] to activate the VBA editor. Now, go to **Insert > Module** and type the following VBA code in the window that comes up:

```
Sub SayHello()  
    MsgBox "Hello!"  
End Sub
```

Press [Alt] + [F11] to return to your workbook and go to **View > Toolbars > Forms** to show the Forms toolbar. Click Button and draw a button on your worksheet somewhere near the cell B2. Release the mouse to get an 'Assign Macro' dialogue box. Choose SayHello and click OK. Next, right-click the button you've created and choose Format Control. Click Properties and make sure that the 'Move and size



You can improve your typing skills and have fun as well, by playing Typing Runner

with cells' option is selected. Click OK and select the rows 1 to 4 or 5, making sure that you select much more than the size of the button. Choose **Edit > Delete** to delete these rows. Protect the sheet using **Tools > Protect Sheet**. Now, click on any cell on the sheet and you will see the 'Hello' dialogue box popping up!

Easter eggs

Easter eggs are the un-documented, entertaining part of a software that come hidden, and require knowledge of specific commands to unravel them. These can be as simple as a scrolling list of developers to full-fledged 3-D games.

One of the most interesting Easter eggs is *Dev Hunt*—a car racing game that lets you shoot at other cars. To play this game, all you need is Excel 2000, Internet Explorer and DirectX.

Open a new Excel workbook. Select **File > Save as Web Page**. In the 'Save As' dialogue box, select 'Publish Sheet' and 'Add Interactivity'. Save this file, and open it in Internet Explorer. Scroll to row 2000, column WC, and click the row heading to select the entire row. If cell WC2000 is not highlighted, press [Tab] to highlight it. Press [Shift] + [Ctrl] + [Alt], and click the Office logo in the upper-left corner. This brings up a full screen, 3D game with the name of the developers written on the road. Use the left and right arrow keys to steer, the up and down arrow keys to accelerate and decelerate respectively, the

Info

Have you ever wondered about the actual size of an Excel worksheet? Well, there are 256 columns and 65,536 rows, which translates to 16,777,216 cells! This is a single worksheet, and a workbook can hold more than one worksheet. If you're using the standard 800 x 600 video mode with the default row heights and column widths, you can see nine columns and 18 rows at a time—less than 0.001 per cent of the entire worksheet.

Entering a single digit into each cell at a speed of one cell per second, will take you about 194 days, non-stop, to fill up a worksheet. Printing the results of your efforts would require more than 36,000 sheets of paper—a stack about six feet tall—and, if you want to increase the size of the worksheet, sorry, the number of rows and columns is fixed. You can't increase it.